

Ways to Connect: Activity & Passion Guide

English

Ways to Connect

Activity & Passion guide

Family and grandchildren

A familiar interest such as Family and grandchildren can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Family and grandchildren can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific family and grandchildren interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or “correct” answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today’s response.

Ways to Connect

Activity & Passion guide

Music

A familiar interest such as Music can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Music can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific music interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or "correct" answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Sports

A familiar interest such as Sports can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Sports can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific sports interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or "correct" answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Activity & Passion guide

Food and recipes

A familiar interest such as Food and recipes can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Food and recipes can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific food and recipes interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or "correct" answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Activity & Passion guide

Travel and places

A familiar interest such as Travel and places can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Travel and places can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific travel and places interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or "correct" answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Gardening

A familiar interest such as Gardening can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Gardening can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific gardening interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or "correct" answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Art and coloring

A familiar interest such as Art and coloring can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Art and coloring can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific art and coloring interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

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NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Familiar objects

A familiar interest such as Familiar objects can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Familiar objects can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific familiar objects interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

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NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Festivals and traditions

A familiar interest such as Festivals and traditions can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Festivals and traditions can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific festivals and traditions interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or "correct" answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Movies and television

A familiar interest such as Movies and television can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Movies and television can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific movies and television interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or "correct" answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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Work and profession

A familiar interest such as Work and profession can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as Work and profession can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific work and profession interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

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NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

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School and college memories

A familiar interest such as School and college memories can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

WHY THIS CAN WORK

A familiar interest such as School and college memories can reduce the demand to invent a topic and create space for stories, preferences, humor, and mutual exchange.

PREPARE

Choose 2–4 large, clear images or one familiar object. Learn the person's preferences; check permission, sound, and comfort.

OPEN GENTLY

"What catches your eye?" "Would you like to look at this together?"

KEEP IT GOING

Ask about feeling, people, places, routines, sounds, smells, or opinions. Share a related detail about yourself.

FOLLOW THE SPARK

Stay when answers grow longer, the person asks a question, smiles, points, hums, or returns to a detail.

PERSONALIZE IT

Use the person's culture, language, era, neighborhood, work, family, and specific school and college memories interests.

SIMPLIFY IT

Use one image, make an observation, offer two choices, or enjoy quiet attention together.

AVOID TURNING IT INTO A TEST

Do not ask for names, dates, scores, lyrics, or "correct" answers. Give information freely.

NEXT TIME

Bring one related image, song, object, or story chosen from today's response.

Evidence note: Informed by the seven systematic reviews and evidence syntheses listed at sageandseed.org/full-references.html. Evidence for communication skills and meaningful interaction is more consistent than evidence for broader clinical outcomes.

This practical resource supports communication and engagement. It is not medical advice, therapy, clinical training, or certification. Follow local safeguarding and supervisory procedures.